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Last week: DJIA 52573.29 ▼ 840.96 1.57% NASDAQ 26333.04 ▼ 0.7% STOXX 600 639.10 ▼ 1.7% 10-YR. TREASURY (Reopening) yield 4.974% OIL \$100.05 ▲ \$8.57 EURO \$1.1601 YEN 153.58

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Recent auto-sales** data indicate that Tesla is once again gaining ground in the U.S. electric-vehicle market as legacy automakers retreat from battery-powered cars. **A1**

◆ **A Polymarket user** earned about \$22,000 with a series of near-perfect bets on the quarterly earnings of companies that had in common KPMG as their auditor. **B1**

◆ **Larry Ellison scrapped** plans to sell up to \$7.5 billion worth of his Oracle stake a day after the company disclosed the billionaire's trading plans. **B3**

◆ **Pfizer, in a roundabout** tactic to collect \$2.2 billion for contracted but unwanted Covid-19 vaccines, is going after money used to pay air-traffic controllers in Poland and Romania. **B1**

◆ **Chip Wilson's divorce** potentially puts at risk the Lululemon founder's roughly \$6 billion fortune and the leverage he has over the athletic company. **B1**

◆ **Football-helmet** makers traditionally declined to sign athletes as pitchers, but now would-be disrupter Light Helmets is writing a playbook that could upend the marketing of this rapidly evolving product. **B1**

◆ **Sunday Ticket**, now distributed by Google's YouTube TV, is expected to carry about 200 NFL games this season, still below what it carried in 2021 when the league boosted its regular season to 17 games per team. **B4**

Worldwide

◆ **Trump and White House** artificial-intelligence adviser David Sacks defended the administration's strategy of minimal regulation of the technology after the heads of top AI companies endorsed a coordinated slowdown of its development. **A1**
◆ **AI agents being tested** by OpenAI attacked a popular software service two months before they hacked the company Hugging Face. **A6**

◆ **Territorial gains by** Iran-backed Houthi militants have made Yemen an important variable in the growing set of interlocked regional conflicts in the Middle East. **A1**

◆ **A 40-year-old** unvaccinated woman died from complications associated with measles in Jefferson County, Pa., the local coroner said. **A3**

◆ **Trump told players** and onlookers at the Irish Open golf tournament that he would rescind the 10% U.S. tariff on Irish whiskey. **A8**

◆ **Trump called on** the Smithsonian Institution to install a 30-foot-tall statue of George Washington in front of the National Museum of American History. **A3**

◆ **Two crypto billionaires** made the biggest political donations in British history to Nigel Farage's Reform UK in a bid to revitalize the anti-immigration party. **A8**

◆ **A Russian jet-powered** drone struck a train close to Ukraine's border with Poland shortly after high-level European officials passed the same stretch of track. **A8**

JOURNAL REPORT

Artificial Intelligence: AI breeds distrust at the office. **R1-6**

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Germany's Zverev Triumphs in the U.S. Open



GEORGE BURKE/IMAGES/REUTERS

NET GAIN: German tennis star Alexander Zverev defeated Ben Shelton in the U.S. Open men's final on Sunday, his second Grand Slam event win this year after a French Open championship. Elena Rybakina captured the women's title Saturday. **A14**

Widening Mideast Instability Squeezes Global Oil Supplies

Houthi offensive in Yemen puts second vital energy corridor under Tehran's sway

By SUMMER SAID
AND SALEH AL-BATATI

DUBAI—Yemen is the latest domino to fall in the chain of instability set off by the U.S. war with Iran, a development that deepens the risk to global energy supplies and complicates efforts to find a diplomatic off-ramp to the conflict. The impoverished country

has long been at war in a forgotten corner of the world. But the lightning offensive by Iran-backed Houthi militants who seized key territory around the strategic Bab al-Mandeb Strait last week has made Yemen an important variable in the growing set of interlocked regional conflicts that are stretching the U.S.'s military capabilities and handing more leverage to Tehran. The U.S. conflict with Iran had sparked a new war in Lebanon between Israel and Hezbollah and pulled in Iraqi militias that had largely sat out three years of war in the region.

Now the Houthi offensive has put the two most important energy corridors in the Middle East—including the Strait of Hormuz on the other side of the Arabian Peninsula—under the sway of Iran and its allies. Saudi Arabia, an energy kingpin and important U.S. military ally, has few safe routes remaining to export its oil. Iranian officials have said the war won't end and shipping routes won't reopen until all of the conflicts in the region are resolved. Persian Gulf states that had hoped for a quick end to the war are now grappling with the realization

that the U.S. has pulled them into a conflict that could run for years with no clear strategy for ending it. "This isn't just a Yemen story," said H.A. Hellyer, a senior fellow at the Royal United Services Institute for Defense and Security Studies, a think tank in London. "Washington's approach to Iran has rested on grinding it down through direct military and economic pressure while assuming the wider region stays manageable. That assumption was always fragile." The chessboard is becoming more complex as the U.S. *Please turn to page A8*

Mark Carney's Audacious EU Bid

As trade talks with the U.S. collapse, Canada pursues risky pivot to Europe

Shortly after Canada and America became embroiled in the worst bilateral trade war in their modern history,

By Drew Hinshaw,
Joe Parkinson and
Laurence Norman

the secure phones of Europe's top leaders lit up with a trans-Atlantic call. Mark Carney was pushing to take Canada's relationship with the EU to the next level—a bold gambit to rewire the economic cabling of the Western alliance.

For months, the Canadian prime minister had held private conversations with almost every major European leader—from France to Italy, Germany and Scandinavia and even some of the continent's lesser-known royals—on how to more deeply plug Canada and its 41 million people into Europe's 27-nation club. Now, Carney was accelerating Canada's pivot to Europe, matchmaking a shotgun marriage to offset the pain of its divorce with *Please turn to page A10*

Wile E. Coyote and Road Runner: Mortal Enemies or Lovers?

A new movie has fans re-evaluating the dynamics behind the endless chase

By ESTHER ZUCKERMAN

Maybe the Road Runner was just playing hard to get. For decades, cartoon canine Wile E. Coyote has been pursuing the speeding bird throughout the American Southwest, aiming to eat him and getting blown up in the process. But in the eyes of some fans, the violent chase was actually a classic tale of tortured love. And right now they're doing a victory lap. That's because of "Coyote vs. Acme," a new film with a different twist on the hot pursuit. In the movie (spoiler alert), Wile E. Coyote sues the

Acme Corporation over their defective products, which consistently backfire as he closes in on the bird. The case goes to a congressional hearing, where Road Runner bursts into the room and becomes the only creature to testify on Coyote's behalf. Through his language of "beeps," Road Runner tells the room he considers Coyote a friend and asks, "Are you coming back?" Apparently that's all the internet needed to hear. "Road Runner admits that he sees Coyote, even whenever Wile E. dislikes him or doesn't think that he's looking," said Lisbon LaSure, a 24-year-old *Please turn to page A12*

INSIDE



PERSONAL JOURNAL
Television's hottest genre is today's job market—and Gen Z's role in it. **A12**

BUSINESS & FINANCE
The divorce of Lululemon's founder and his wife puts his fortune at risk. **B1**

Bessent Says Growth Is Key to Debt Fight

By RICHARD RUBIN
AND JUSTIN LAHART

The U.S. debt picture looks bleak. Is there a way out of the coming crunch? One path requires tough trade-offs lawmakers have ducked for decades: higher taxes and lower spending. Another route sounds more appealing: growth. Even if the country owes trillions more dollars, additional debt will matter less if the economy booms even faster. That is the tale Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent and administration officials have touted as the U.S. crossed borrowing milestones, with publicly held debt hitting 100% of gross domestic product and

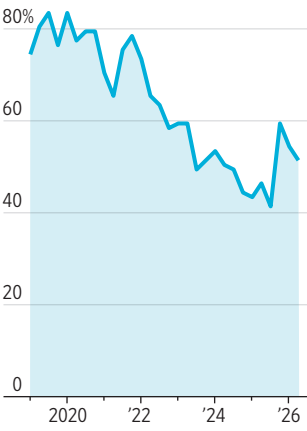
gross debt topping \$40 trillion. Bessent sketched a scenario where the government benefits from growth fueled by the artificial-intelligence build-out, reshored manufacturing and tax cuts for consumers. "With 3% growth, we grow our way out of this," Bessent said at Southern Methodist University last week, arguing that the economy was headed there before the Iran war disrupted energy flows. "We'll get to the other side of this Iran conflict, and the underlying economy is very, very strong, and I think reaccelerating." Bessent and President Trump lean on the growth argument for improving the U.S. fiscal posture while the admin- *Please turn to page A2*

Tesla's Presence in U.S. EV Market Rises as Legacy Automakers Retreat

By CHRISTOPHER OTTS

Elon Musk once predicted that an end to the U.S.'s federal electric-vehicle tax credit would be painful for Tesla at first, but ultimately beneficial to the automaker in the long run. He was right, at least in a relative sense. Recent auto-sales data indicate that Tesla is once again gaining ground in the U.S. EV market as legacy automakers retreat from battery-powered cars. Musk's company is back to comprising more than half of the U.S. EV market, with a 52% share in 2026 through August, up from 43% a year earlier, according to Motor Intelligence. The company hasn't escaped the wider EV downturn.

Tesla's U.S. EV market share



Source: Cox Automotive

Tesla's 325,351 U.S. sales so far this year represent a 16% decline from a year earlier. However, the overall EV mar-

ket has contracted more, down 30%. Once accounting for more than 80% of U.S. EV sales, Tesla's market share in recent years saw a multiyear slide as old-school carmakers like Hyundai, Ford and General Motors introduced their own electric models. Tesla's share eroded to a record low of 41% in 2025 as Musk's foray into politics and work downsizing the federal government with the Trump administration turned away some buyers and sparked protests outside its stores. Now, the Austin, Texas, company is regaining ground, even as it has de-emphasized its core auto business. Musk canceled Tesla's luxury Models S and X without replacements *Please turn to page A2*